

Process guide

From strategy creation to project registration

This guide is for the client and business stakeholders. It explains how the process moves, step by step, who is responsible at each stage, and what happens after each decision — with no technical detail.

AUDIENCE

Client and decision makers

PROCESS SCOPE

From an approved idea to a registered project

END RESULT

An official project linked to strategy, funding, and procurement

Why this process exists

A technology investment does not start by “opening a project”. It starts with a clear intent: what do we want to achieve? Why do we need funding? And is the approved amount the same amount that will later be bought against?

The platform keeps those questions on one unbroken path. Every initiative carries a single follow-up number that travels with the strategy, then the demand, then the budget, then procurement, then the registered project. Leadership can then see that the final project came from an approved objective, approved funding, and completed buying — not from scattered files.

The platform covers the stage before day-to-day delivery. The process ends at **project registration** with the Project Management Office. Delivery work then continues in the usual project tools, while the link and the impact remain visible here.

Who works in this process?

Role	What they do	When they appear
Strategy & Governance	Drafts the strategy, objectives, and performance measures, and reviews architecture and data governance when needed.	At the start, and in some reviews after the demand is submitted.
Business Owner	Owns the demand case, completes the remaining content, and makes the final demand submission.	After the demand is created, and before funding.
Commercial & Budgeting	Builds the budget lines, writes the funding recommendation, and sends the pack for technology-office approval.	After the demand is commercially accepted.

Role	What they do	When they appear
CTO Office	Approves the strategy, reviews security when needed, and approves the budget.	At the main approval gates.
Project Management Office	Follows procurement through to receipt, then registers the project officially.	After funding is approved, until the project is registered.

If the screen says approval is waiting for a specific role, switch to that role before making the decision.

The full picture in twelve steps

This is the complete strategic path. The pages that follow explain each stage in detail.

1

Create a strategy

A new draft with title, scope, indicative funding, and objectives.

2

Submit the strategy for approval

The draft is locked and waits for the technology office.

3

Approve the strategy

The strategy is complete. No demand or budget is created automatically.

4

Create a demand

A business case linked to the approved strategy, or a standalone case with a written reason.

5

Initial handoff to the Business Owner

Whoever created the demand sends it on. After that, only the Business Owner can edit it.

6

Final demand submission

The Business Owner completes options and details, then submits. A budget draft is created.

7

Reviews if needed

Architecture, security, or data — only if the demand marked an impact there.

8

Commercial validation of the demand

Completeness, no unnoticed duplicate, then accept or return.

9

Build the budget and consolidation pack

Clear lines, a written funding narrative, then send for approval.

10

Approve the budget

After approval, a procurement plan opens against the approved amount.

11

Procurement through to receipt

Each card moves one stage at a time until acceptance or completion.

12

Register the project

The PMO registers the official project on the same follow-up chain.

Stage 1 — Write the strategy

Strategy & Governance

Start from Home and create a new record of type **Strategy**. A draft opens for completion. This is not a project yet. It is the frame that sets direction, boundaries, and priorities.

What to fill in

1. Title, type, executive summary, vision, mission, and drivers.
2. Current state and target state, what is in scope and what is out of scope.
3. An indicative funding envelope in SAR (capital and operating). This is a guiding ceiling, not a budget approval.
4. Strategic objectives, with a weight for each so the weights add up to 100%.
5. Under each objective: performance measures (name, unit, target, source, owner). If measures inside an objective have weights, those must also add up to 100%.
6. Save as you go.

No demand and no budget are created at this stage. The strategy is finished when it is approved. The demand is created later, by a deliberate choice.

Stage 2 — Submit and approve the strategy

Strategy & Governance then CTO Office

Submission

1. Once objectives and weights are complete, submit the strategy to the strategy approval gate.
2. The draft is locked so it cannot be edited during review.
3. It appears in the technology-office approval list.

Technology-office decision

- **Approve:** the strategy is complete and locked. A demand can now be created and linked to it.
- **Approve with conditions:** the same result, with mandatory conditions text.

- **Return for revision:** it is unlocked for correction, with a mandatory comment. Re-submission raises the version number and keeps the history.
- **Reject:** the case is closed in place and is not reopened as a new draft on the same receipt. If needed, a new path is started.

After approval, you can create a demand linked to this strategy. The budget still does not appear until that demand is later submitted.

Stage 3 — Create the demand (business case)

The demand answers “why do we need this investment?”. Create it from the demand list, or from Create demand after the strategy is approved.

Demand linked to a strategy

1. Create a new demand.
2. On Identity, select the approved strategy.
3. The demand stays on the same follow-up chain as the strategy.

Standalone demand (no strategy)

1. Leave the linked strategy empty.
2. Write a clear standalone justification (at least twenty characters).
3. The rest of the process still applies and remains auditable. Bypass is allowed. Hiding the bypass is not.

What the business case contains

1. Title, urgency, impact, current state, problem or opportunity, in scope and out of scope, and the strategic contribution.
2. Indicative costs: one-off, recurring, and an approximate total in SAR.
3. Solution options, including a do-nothing option if any options are listed.
4. Expected benefits, plus risks, assumptions, dependencies, and constraints.
5. If there is an impact on architecture, security and privacy, or data governance, mark it here. Later reviews depend on those flags.

Stage 4 — Initial handoff, then final submission

The demand is not locked for everyone on the first submit. The process is deliberately in two parts:

1) Initial submit — whoever created the demand

If someone other than the Business Owner created the demand (for example Strategy & Governance or the CTO Office), they complete Identity, the business case, and alignment, then click **Submit to Business Owner**.

- They are not asked to finish the solution options at this point, so the process does not stop on detail that is not their job.
- After this submit, the case moves to the Business Owner.
- The person who made the initial submit is **locked out**: they can no longer edit.
- No reviews open, and no budget is created at this moment.

2) Final submit — Business Owner only

Business Owner

1. Open the demand and complete options, technical, finance, and registers.
2. If options are listed, mark one as do-nothing / base case.
3. Confirm that the business-case content is accurate and complete.
4. Submit the demand. The record is now locked on the official path, and a **budget draft** is created on the same follow-up chain.

If the Business Owner created the demand from the start, they complete every tab and make the final submit directly, with no handoff in between.

Stage 5 — Conditional reviews (may be skipped)

This stage appears only if the demand marked a specific impact:

If the demand marked	Who reviews?	What can they decide?
Architecture impact	Strategy & Governance	Endorse, endorse with conditions, or return
Security / privacy impact	CTO Office	Endorse, endorse with conditions, or return
Data-governance impact	Strategy & Governance	Endorse, endorse with conditions, or return

1. The reviewer reads the case and writes an assessment.
2. The demand is not ready for funding while any of those reviews remain open.
3. If no impact flag was raised, this stage is skipped, and the skip is recorded — it is not hidden.

Stage 6 — Validate the demand

Commercial & Budgeting

1. Open the validation list.
2. Check completeness: title, problem, scope, indicative cost, and start dates where needed.
3. Check for possible duplicates against other submitted or in-review demands. If a similar case appears, merge or justify continuing. Do not ignore it.
4. Record the decision: accept, accept with conditions, or return.

A demand accepted here is the base that budget lines hang from.

Stage 7 — Budget lines and the consolidation pack

Commercial & Budgeting

The budget draft was created at the final demand submission. Before that, no budget appears for this initiative.

Budget lines

1. Open the budget on the same follow-up number.
2. Add at least one line: description, type, operating or capital, category, quantity, unit price, contingency, and requested total in SAR.
3. Watch the totals at the top: operating, capital, contingency, estimated tax, and grand total.
4. The requested amount must be greater than zero.
5. If a real funding ceiling exists and the request exceeds it, a warning appears and does not necessarily block save. If the ceiling is zero, the over-commit warning will not fire.
6. Save the lines.

Consolidation pack (before funding approval)

1. From budget lines, open the consolidation pack.
2. Write the funding narrative (at least twenty characters) and the recommendation.
3. Save governance.
4. Confirm requested versus validated versus approved ceiling in writing.

Without this written narrative, the budget cannot be sent for approval. The pack is the on-screen text, not a file that replaces it.

Send for funding approval

1. Still as Commercial & Budgeting, submit the budget to the budget approval gate.
2. The figures lock and wait for the technology office.

Stage 8 — Approve the budget

CTO Office

1. Open the submitted budget.
2. Confirm that open validation findings are cleared, if any.
3. Choose one of these decisions:
 - **Approve:** the budget is locked and approved. A procurement plan and buying items are created against the approved amount.
 - **Approve with conditions:** the same result, with mandatory conditions text.
 - **Return the pack:** it goes back to finance with a mandatory comment.
 - **Return selected lines:** only the chosen lines go back; the rest stay in the pack.
 - **Reject:** the submission is closed. No approved funding, and no procurement from this receipt.

After approval, the figures are the official version. Approved cells are not edited by hand. Any change is made through an official return, then a new cycle. Do not click Approve a second time after the decision is complete.

Stage 9 — Procurement through to receipt

Project Management Office or commercial execution, as assigned

Procurement plan

1. Open Procurement and select the budget that was just approved.
2. Review title, period, owner, available funding, planned value, and item count.
3. Every buying item must sit on an approved budget line and must not exceed that line's ceiling in SAR.

Tracking board

Each card moves one stage at a time, in this order:

1. Planned
2. Purchase-request preparation
3. Purchase-request approval
4. Market competition
5. Evaluation
6. Award
7. Commitment
8. Delivery
9. Acceptance
10. Completed

A card may move to Cancelled as a side path, not from Completed.

- Move one stage, wait until the board settles, then move again. Skipping stages is not saved.
- Actual or expected commitment must not exceed the approved item budget by more than a small agreed margin.
- From award onward, the committed amount can be recorded on the card.
- PMO handoff becomes ready at **Acceptance** or **Completed**.

Stage 10 — Register the project

Project Management Office

The registration list shows received or completed items that do not yet have a registered project.

1. Open the PMO handoff from the procurement card, or from the project-registration gate.
2. Confirm readiness: the demand is accepted, the budget is approved, procurement is at acceptance or completed, and the pack is complete.
3. Register the project: name, project manager, delivery method, planned dates, and the project budget inherited from the buying item, with links to measures and objectives.
4. Submit registration. The official project is created on the same follow-up chain.
5. Confirm the row appears in the project register.

A project cannot be registered while the item is still in planning, competition, or award only. Receipt or completion is required before registration.

After registration — what leadership sees

This is not a second process. These are views of the same chain:

- **Projects:** the official register, status, and budget.
- **Performance:** actual versus target on the measures.
- **Value realization:** benefits promised on the demand versus what is delivered after registration.
- **Traceability:** from strategy to objective to demand to budget line to buying item to project.
- **Evidence:** attachments, comments, and approval receipts.
- **Reports and the one-pager:** an executive summary. Do not treat the figures as approved fact until at least one budget has passed the funding gate.

Short path if you start from a demand with no strategy

1. Create a demand, leave the strategy link empty, and write the standalone justification.
2. If the creator is not the Business Owner, send the initial handoff, then the Business Owner makes the final submit.
3. Continue from reviews (if any), then validation, budget, funding approval, procurement, and project registration.

Practical rules that prevent confusion

- No budget opens before the final demand submission.
- Approving the strategy is not enough to create a project.
- Approving the budget is what opens procurement.
- PMO registration is what turns the chain into an official project.
- Every return is recorded. The approved version is not quietly replaced.
- If approval will not proceed, first confirm that the correct role is making the decision.

End of the process: approved strategy → complete and accepted demand → approved budget → received procurement → registered project. Leadership can then

say with confidence: this project came through governance, not from a side file.